

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1645

By Hicks G

A RESOLUTION to honor the fallen law enforcement officers of Hawkins County during National Police Week and on Peace Officers Memorial Day.

WHEREAS, the preservation of public safety and domestic tranquility depends upon the enforcement of laws designed to protect life, liberty, and property; and

WHEREAS, this responsibility is entrusted to dedicated law enforcement officers who serve with courage, integrity, and a steadfast commitment to justice; and

WHEREAS, these officers routinely face danger and adversity, placing themselves in harm's way to protect the citizens of Hawkins County and communities across the United States; and

WHEREAS, many officers have suffered injury, disability, and hardship as a result of their service, and far too many have made the ultimate sacrifice, giving their lives in the line of duty; and

WHEREAS, since the first recorded line-of-duty death in 1786, more than 24,500 law enforcement officers in the United States have lost their lives protecting others, and their names are forever memorialized as a testament to their bravery and sacrifice; and

WHEREAS, the fallen law enforcement officers from Hawkins County include Farris Ward, who was shot and killed on December 12, 1930; William Frye who was shot and killed on December 30, 1931; Drew Harrell, who died in an automobile accident on June 15, 1937; John Wesley Wright, who was accidentally shot and killed by another officer on August 16, 1988; and Deputy Gerald "Bubba" Gibson, who was killed in the line of duty on July 13, 2000; and

WHEREAS, the service and sacrifice of these fallen heroes, including those from Tennessee and Hawkins County, are honored annually during National Police Week, which this year will be observed May 11-16, 2026; and

WHEREAS, May 15, 2026, will be observed as Peace Officers Memorial Day, a day set aside to honor all fallen officers and to recognize the enduring sacrifices made by their families; and

WHEREAS, it is both fitting and proper that the citizens of Hawkins County remember and honor those who have given their lives in service to others and express gratitude to those who continue to serve; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the fallen law enforcement officers of Hawkins County during National Police Week (May 11-16, 2026) and on Peace Officers Memorial Day (May 15, 2026).

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we join with the people of Hawkins County in commending the ongoing service of law enforcement personnel, supporting the families of fallen law enforcement officers, and paying tribute to the valor, dedication, and enduring legacy of these brave peace officers, whose courage will never be forgotten.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.